

Eleutherodactylus planirostris

Greenhouse frog



Length 1–1½ in (2.5–4 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding season Summer
Status Least concern

Location S.E. USA, Caribbean



This tiny frog—one of the world’s smallest—belongs to a family of about 201 species that are found throughout warm parts of the Americas. It is brown or tan, with darker mottling or stripes on its back, and well-developed adhesive disks on its fingers and toes. The greenhouse frog usually lives in wooded habitats, but also enters gardens. Like its many relatives, it lays eggs in moist places on the ground, that hatch directly into fully formed frogs.

Bufo bufo

European common toad



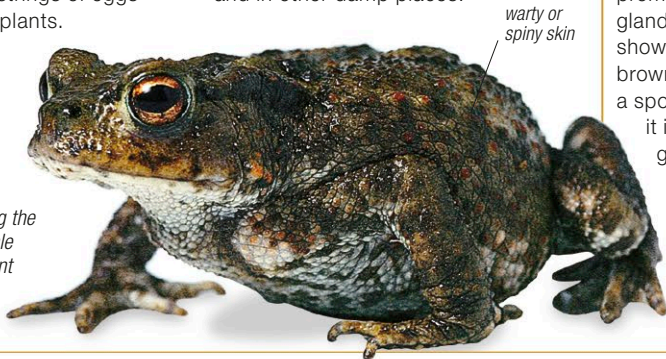
Length 3¼–8 in (8–20 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring
Status Least concern

Location N.W. Africa, Europe to C. Asia



One of Europe’s most widespread amphibians, the European common toad is a robust animal with a warty or spine-covered skin. Its color ranges from brown or green to brick-red, and females are generally substantially larger than males, particularly in early spring, when they are laden with eggs. At this time of year, males and females congregate in ponds and, after pairing up, the female lays strings of eggs around underwater plants. During the rest of the year, this

APPEARANCE
This common toad has large, copper- or gold-colored eyes. During the breeding season, the male develops pads on his front feet for gripping the female.



IN SELF-DEFENSE



The European common toad has a large parotid gland behind each eye, which exudes a distasteful secretion to ward off predators. If threatened, it often swells up by gulping air, and stands on tiptoe to make itself look larger. Despite its menacing appearance, it rarely bites and is harmless to humans.

toad spends much of its time away from water, feeding on insects, slugs, and other small animals. It is mainly nocturnal, hiding by day under logs and in other damp places.

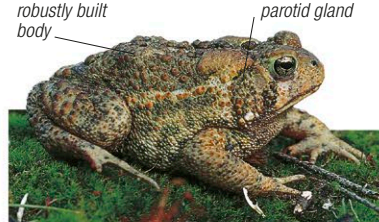
Anaxyrus americanus

American toad



Length 2–3½ in (5–9 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring
Status Least concern

Location E. Canada, E. USA



Like the European common toad (see left), the American toad has warty skin, prominent eyes, and a large parotid gland on each side of its head. It shows great variation in color, from brown to brightly colored, and has a spotted chest. An adaptable animal, it is found in all habitats, including gardens and mountains, and is active at night. During courtship, males produce a musical trill lasting 3 to 60 seconds to attract mates. Females lay eggs in long strings in ponds, wrapped around vegetation.

Pristimantis mutabilis

Mutable rainfrog



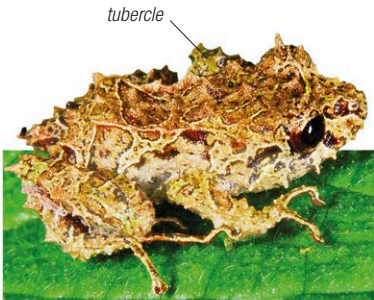
Length 1⅞–1⅝ in (1.7–2.4 cm)
Habit Arboreal
Breeding season Not recorded
Status Endangered

Location Northern Ecuador



Discovered in 2013, this species from northern Ecuador is pale brown to grayish green, with dark patches on its upperside. It also has a thin orange line running along each side of the back. The mutable rainfrog

gets its name from its ability to alter the texture of its skin radically. It can go from being smooth to being covered in numerous spinelike protuberances (tubercles) within a matter of minutes, though the function of this transformation is not known.



Pseudepidalea viridis

European green toad



Length 2¼–3½ in (6–9 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring and summer
Status Least concern

Location E. Europe, Asia



This robust toad has pale skin with green marbling and red spots. It prefers sandy habitats in lowlands and dry places, but is also found in mountain regions and in

urban areas. It spends winter and dry periods under logs, rocks, or buried in rotting vegetation. Active at night, it feeds mainly on insects. During courtship, the male makes a high-pitched call. A female European green toad may lay between 10,000 and 12,000 eggs at a time.



Amietophrynus gutturalis

Guttural toad



Length 2–4 in (5–10 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa



The guttural toad is found in a variety of sites that provide cover, close to ponds, dams, and streams. In urban areas, it can often be seen under streetlights at night, feeding on insects. However, it also preys on other invertebrates and on flying termites as they leave their nest. The female is larger than the male, but the latter has longer forelimbs. Both sexes are pale brown with dark brown patches. The male makes a deep guttural “snore” to attract a mate, and the female lays eggs in water.

Amietophrynus rangeri

Raucous toad



Length 2–4¼ in (5–11 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa



This yellow or pale brown, spotted toad inhabits grassland and woodland close to rivers, streams, and ponds. In cool and dry spells, it hides under logs or rocks, or in rotting vegetation. When cornered by a predator, it produces a sticky, distasteful secretion through its parotid glands. During the breeding season, males let out loud, harsh “quacks” to attract females. Mating activity, such as calling and fighting, is extremely energetic, and males lose weight at this time of year.

